

theLook: where revenue leaks and what to fix first

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To: Head of Growth, theLook. From: B Nikhileshwar, Data Analyst.

Revenue is growing more than 40% a year, but three leaks hold it back: 58% of carts are abandoned, 25% of orders are cancelled or returned, and 69% of buyers never buy again. Fix checkout first, because it is the largest loss and the easiest to measure.

Key numbers

All figures cover January 2019 to 4 October 2026 and exclude cancelled and returned orders unless stated.

Metric	Value	What it says
Kept revenue	8.12 million	Up 46% in 2025; January to September 2026 is already 35% above all of 2025
Valid orders	93,999	Out of 124,966 placed
Average order value	86.36	Revenue per valid order
Gross margin	51.9%	Sale price less product cost
Cart-to-purchase rate	41.9%	58.1% of carts are abandoned
Cancel or return rate	24.8%	14.9% cancelled, 9.9% returned
Repeat purchase rate	30.7%	20,391 of 66,349 buyers ordered again

Findings

- Checkout is the biggest leak.** Of 431,636 sessions that added to cart, 181,033 purchased. The other 250,603, or 58.1%, left without buying.
- One in four orders is not kept.** 30,967 of 124,966 orders were cancelled (18,611) or returned (12,356). At the average order value, that is roughly 2.7 million in order value lost.

3. **Most buyers buy once.** 45,958 of 66,349 buyers, or 69.3%, never ordered again. In any month after the first order, only about 1.6% of buyers return, and that rate stays flat through month 12.
4. **Channels do not differ in customer quality.** All five sit within 65% to 67% for sign-ups who buy, 30% to 31% for repeat rate, and 119 to 123 for revenue per buyer. Search brings 70% of customers.
5. **Two categories carry a quarter of revenue.** Outerwear & Coats and Jeans make up 24% of revenue. Jeans has the lowest margin of the top five at 46.4%; Suits & Sport Coats has the highest at 59.8%.

Recommended actions

1. **Fix checkout first.** Test cart-abandonment reminders and a shorter checkout. Target: cart-to-purchase from 41.9% to 45%. That is about 13,400 more purchases, worth roughly 600,000 in kept revenue at current averages.
2. **Cut cancellations and returns.** Break the 24.8% down by category and reason, then act on the top two causes. Target: 22%. Each point recovered is about 1,250 orders, or roughly 108,000 in order value.
3. **Win the second order.** Send a second-purchase offer within 30 days of first delivery. Target: repeat rate from 30.7% to 35%, which is about 2,850 more repeat buyers.

On marketing, customer quality is the same across channels, so budget should follow cost per new buyer. That needs spend data, which this dataset does not hold.

Method and limits

The numbers come from a snapshot of the public thelook_ecommerce dataset taken on 4 October 2026, modelled in BigQuery with dbt (15 models, 20 automated data tests) and charted in Data Studio.

- The dataset is synthetic. It is useful for showing the method, but the patterns are more uniform than real customer behaviour.
- It holds no marketing spend, so acquisition cost and return on spend cannot be calculated.
- Each website session maps to one purchased item, so the funnel counts items, not baskets.

- The revenue estimates in the actions assume today's average values hold. They are sizing figures, not forecasts.
- Amounts are in the dataset's currency unit, which the source does not name.